Interview guide: your life with religion

60 minutes, one person. Bring: the 11×17 life map, a marker, a gift card, a card with 988 (call or text, US).

Before you start

5 min

> *"Thank you for doing this. Today isn't about any product. I'd love to hear your story with religion and faith, in your own words. There are no right answers and I'm not here to change what you believe. Skip anything you like. Is it okay if I record so I can listen instead of writing? It stays private, and I won't use your name."*

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1 · Warm-up

5 min

1. Tell me a little about yourself.
2. How did religion show up in your house growing up?

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2 · The life map

25 min · 5 to draw, 20 to talk

> *"Draw one line from your birth to today. Go up when you felt close to faith, down when you felt far from it. There's no wrong way to draw it."*

Give them 5 quiet minutes. Then walk the line together, left to right, writing a word or two next to each rise and dip.

- **Any point:** What was happening in your life here? Who was around you?
- **Rises:** What pulled you closer? A person, a place, a ritual, a crisis?
- **Dips:** What pushed you away, or let it fade? Did you ever feel judged or like an outsider?
- **Flat stretches:** Peaceful, empty, or just busy? Did you miss anything?
- **Big events** (a birth, a death, a move, a marriage, an illness): Did faith help, get in the way, or not show up?
- **To finish:** Put a ★ at the moments that mattered most. Where do you hope the line goes next? If something could have shown up for you at the right moment on this line, where would that be, and what would it have done?

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3 · Today

10 min

3. Walk me through the last time you did something religious or spiritual.
4. Is there anything you do or say that you don't fully understand?
5. (If they attend) When you leave your house of faith, what's missing?
6. Does anyone ask you about your faith: your kids, a partner, a coworker? What happens?

3b · Families

if they have kids or a partner of another religion · takes 5 min from part 4

- When your kids ask about your religion, what do they ask? What do you say? How does that feel?
- (Two religions at home) How did you decide what to teach the kids? Who had a say: you, your partner, the grandparents?

- What do you most want your kids to understand, or keep, from your religion?
- What does your partner's religion mean to them that you wish you understood better?

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4 · What you've tried

5–10 min

7. Is there anyone whose religion you'd like to understand better? Why?
8. What have you tried: an app, a book, a podcast, a class? What kept you, and what made you stop?
9. What would feel wrong or annoying coming from an app about faith?
10. If something truly helped you here, what would make paying for it feel fair?

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5 · Wrap-up

5 min

11. If you had a wise friend who knew your tradition well, what would you ask them first?
12. Is there anything I didn't ask that I should have?
13. Who else should I talk to?

> *"Thank you, this was generous of you. If any of this stirred something up, please reach out to someone you trust, and if you're ever in crisis, you can call or text 988."*

Tips

- Ask for stories ("tell me about the last time..."), then "tell me more." Let silences sit.
- Never pitch, correct, debate, or share your own story.
- If someone gets upset, stop and offer a break or to end. They keep the gift card.

Right after

10 min

1. Photograph the map.
2. Note: what pulled them in, what pushed them away, one exact quote, one surprise.
3. Finish the sentence: "To show up for this person, we'd need to ___."